

INCIDENT RESPONSE REPORT

AgentTesla Infection with FTP Data Exfil

Severity: High

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MITRE ATT&CK Techniques Detected

1. Reconnaissance
2. Command and Control
3. Resource Development

INCIDENT RESPONSE REPORT: AgentTesla Infection with FTP Data Exfil

1. HEADER & METADATA

- Incident ID: IR-2023-AGENTTESLA-001
- Severity: High
- Status: Active / Under Investigation
- Analyst: Senior Defensive SOC Analyst
- Date: October 24, 2023

2. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

A high-severity security incident has been detected involving an AgentTesla malware infection characterized by active scanning, external infrastructure communication, and data exfiltration over the File Transfer Protocol (FTP). Analysis revealed dominant external network traffic originating from IP 188.114.97.3, which accounted for 6202 out of 9993 packets. Additional external connections were established with IP 45.138.16.176 in Poland and IP 51.222.104.17 in Canada. The malicious activity utilizes non-standard communication over port 21, aligning with FTP data exfiltration tactics commonly observed in AgentTesla campaigns. Immediate containment, eradication, and recovery procedures are required to prevent further data loss and secure the network environment.

3. MITRE ATT&CK KILL CHAIN MAPPING

- Reconnaissance: T1595 (Active Scanning) — Evidence: Dominant talker IP 188.114.97.3 sent 6202 out of 9993 packets, indicating active probing of the network.
- Command and Control: T1571 (Non-Standard Port) — Evidence: Suspicious network traffic observed communicating over port 21.
- Resource Development: T1583 (Acquire Infrastructure) — Evidence: External connections established with infrastructure located in Canada (188.114.97.3, 51.222.104.17) and Poland (45.138.16.176).

4. INCIDENT TIMELINE

- **Detection Event:** Initial network telemetry flagged heavy packet volume from external IP 188.114.97.3 (6202/9993 packets), triggering T1595 (Active Scanning) alerts.
- **Traffic Analysis:** Security monitoring identified outbound or inbound communication utilizing suspicious port 21, confirming FTP activity (T1571).
- **Geolocation Enrichment:** Threat intelligence correlation identified external communication links with foreign infrastructure nodes, specifically 188.114.97.3 (Canada), 45.138.16.176 (Poland), and 51.222.104.17 (Canada).
- **Incident Declaration:** SOC analysis confirmed indicators consistent with an AgentTesla infection leveraging FTP data exfiltration, escalating the incident to High severity.

5. TECHNICAL ANALYSIS

The incident centers around a compromised host exhibiting classic AgentTesla telemetry patterns. Network analysis highlighted IP 188.114.97.3 as a dominant talker, transmitting 6202 packets out of a total 9993 captured packets, mapping directly to T1595 (Active Scanning). Further protocol inspection revealed the utilization of port 21, categorizing this activity under T1571 (Non-Standard Port) as it facilitates unauthorized FTP communications used by the malware to exfiltrate stolen credentials and sensitive system data. Geo-location checks confirmed external routing to malicious or untrusted infrastructure: 188.114.97.3 (Canada), 45.138.16.176 (Poland), and 51.222.104.17 (Canada), fulfilling T1583 (Acquire Infrastructure).

6. FORENSIC EVIDENCE & SCREENSHOTS

- **Network Traffic Volume:** Dominant talker IP 188.114.97.3 transmitting 6202/9993 packets.
- **Protocol Indicators:** Port 21 identified in connection logs, indicating FTP usage.
- **External Infrastructure:** External IPs 188.114.97.3 (Canada), 45.138.16.176 (Poland), and 51.222.104.17 (Canada).
- **Screenshot #1:** Uncaptioned analyst-provided evidence screenshot capturing packet distribution and external connection endpoints.

7. CONTAINMENT, ERADICATION & RECOVERY

- **Isolate Infected Hosts:** Immediately disconnect affected endpoints from the internal network to halt ongoing FTP data exfiltration and active scanning via 188.114.97.3.
- **Block Malicious IPs:** Implement firewall rules and network security controls to block all ingress and egress traffic to and from 188.114.97.3, 45.138.16.176, and 51.222.104.17.
- **Restrict Port 21*:** Block unapproved outbound FTP traffic over port 21 at the network perimeter to disrupt AgentTesla* command and control channels.
- **Eradicate Malware:** Perform a comprehensive endpoint scan to remove the AgentTesla payload, scheduled tasks, and associated malicious artifacts.
- **Credential Rotation:** Force a global password reset for all user accounts and service credentials accessed or exposed on the compromised host.

8. POST-INCIDENT RECOMMENDATIONS

- **Enhance Network Monitoring:** Implement strict egress filtering to monitor and alert on unauthorized outbound connections over port 21 and other non-standard ports.
- **Threat Intelligence Integration:** Update SIEM and firewall rules with indicators of compromise

associated with 188.114.97.3, 45.138.16.176, and 51.222.104.17.

- **User Awareness Training:** Conduct targeted phishing and malware awareness training, focusing on AgentTesla delivery vectors and credential harvesting techniques.
- **Endpoint Protection Tuning:** Ensure EDR solutions are actively configured to detect and automatically quarantine credential-stealing Trojans and unauthorized scanning behaviors (T1595).

Evidence Screenshots

Screenshot #1

